

MARKETING SWEET · ROLEPLAY 02

The 60-Second Pre-Meeting Confirmation Call

Session tie-in: Session 02 — Big Energy, Better Research, Stop Hunting Excuses

Difficulty: Easy · **Run time:** ~10 min · **Reps required:** 2

The setup

It's Thursday afternoon. You've got a meeting locked in with **Joel Renshaw** at *Joel Renshaw Landscaping* tomorrow morning (Friday) at 10am. Joel's an 8-staff outfit doing mostly residential landscaping, but he's just started bidding for commercial work and you suspect he's underestimating what he's capable of. Estimated turnover ~\$1.2M — but multiply by ~2x because he'll under-state.

You haven't spoken to Joel since the original booking call 9 days ago. The phone call you're about to make has two jobs: 1. Pull final data points you need for tomorrow's pitch (no more than three). 2. Set the tone — high energy, brief, you hang up first.

You are the rep. Joel picks up the phone.

Coaching note — before you start: This entire call is 60–90 seconds. If it goes longer than that, you've already lost the win. Reps who treat this as a “quick chat” overstay and erode the credibility this call is supposed to build.

THE SCRIPT

REP: Hey Joel — Lucas here from Marketing Sweet, how are ya, mate?

JOEL: Yeah, good mate, what's up?

REP: I'm flat out — I know you are too. Just doing my prep for tomorrow's meeting. Three quick questions for you while I'm running keyword research and the AdWords-vs-SEO projections. Got two minutes?

Coaching note: High energy from word one. The phrase “flat out” signals you're not wasting time — yours or his. Mentioning specific prep work (“keyword research, AdWords-vs-SEO projections”) signals competence and seriousness. You've also locked the time horizon at two minutes, which makes the rest of the call feel disciplined.

JOEL: Yeah, mate, fire away.

REP: Beauty. One — roughly how many jobs are you running per day on average at the moment?

JOEL: Right now? Probably two to three a day across the team. Sometimes four if we're flat out.

REP: Perfect. Two — what's your average job value on a residential project?

JOEL: Most of them sit between four and eight grand. Bigger ones, like full backyard makeovers, can hit 25.

REP: Excellent. Last one — who are you up against locally? Who's the main competitor that comes up over and over?

JOEL: Mostly *Adelaide Garden Design* and *Quirk Landscapes*. Quirk are getting more of the bigger ones lately.

REP: Perfect. That's exactly what I needed. I've got everything I need for the projections — see you tomorrow at ten, mate. Have a great one.

JOEL: Yeah cheers, see ya.

[Rep hangs up immediately. Total call time: ~75 seconds.]

Coaching note: You hung up first. That's the rule. If Joel had said "actually mate, just one more thing —" you'd hear it out, but the moment your three questions are answered, you wrap. Reps who say "anything else you wanted to flag?" turn a 75-second power call into a 12-minute meandering one and burn the goodwill.

THE FORK — Joel tries to extend the call:

JOEL: Yeah mate, we've been flat out lately. Last week we did this huge job out at Mount Barker, full retaining wall, three days of work, looked unreal —

Coaching note: Joel wants to chat. Don't reward it. Acknowledge briefly, redirect to the call's purpose, then move on. He'll get to tell you the full story tomorrow.

REP: Mate, sounds like a cracker — keen to hear the full story tomorrow. I've got to keep moving though — one more question while I've got you and then I'll let you crack on. Who's the main competitor that comes up?

Coaching note: Notice what just happened: you didn't shut him down, you affirmed him and moved on. He doesn't feel dismissed; he feels like he's talking to someone valuable enough to want to save the story for in person.

STRETCH VARIATIONS

- **Joel says "I can't really talk right now, I'm on a job site."** Don't try to push the three questions. Respond with: "No worries, mate — quick text instead?" Send three questions by text. You've still gathered the data and protected his time.

- **Joel volunteers something unexpected.** (“Actually mate, we’re thinking of pulling the meeting back to next month — got cash flow stuff going on.”) Run the diagnostic — is this affordability (real, vet it now), intent (real, surface it now), or just a stall? Don’t lose the meeting on a phone call — book a re-confirm conversation for next week instead.
 - **Joel says his turnover is ~\$600k.** Multiply by 2x in your head. He’s under-stating. Pitch tomorrow as though he’s a \$1.2M operator and you’ll land in the right anchor.
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WHAT TO LOOK FOR WHEN YOU’RE PRACTISING THIS

- Did the rep hang up first, or did they let Joel close the call?
- Was the rep’s energy noticeably higher than a normal cold call? Did they sound like they were prepping serious work, or just rattling off questions?
- Did the rep stick to three questions, or scope-creep to five?
- Did the rep reference *real* prep work (keyword research, projections, etc), or was it generic?
- Total call time — was it under 90 seconds?

If the call goes over two minutes, debrief specifically: what got added that didn’t need to be there?